City of Masvingo (Human Excreta and Dangerous Substances) By-laws, 2025

ARRANGEMENT OF SECTIONS

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SCHEDULE: Offences and penalties.

IT is hereby notified that the Minister responsible for Local Government has in terms of section 229 of the Urban Councils Act [*Chapter 29:15*] approved the following by-laws:—

Title

1. These by-laws may be cited as the City of Masvingo (Human Excreta and Dangerous Substances) By-laws, 2025.

Application

2. These by-laws shall apply within City of Masvingo area.

Interpretation

3. In these by-laws—

"council" means City of Masvingo;

"dangerous substance" means any liquid, gas or solid that poses a risk to human health or safety;

"designated officer" means any person employed or delegated by Council to carry out functions prescribed in these by-laws;

"edible plant" means plant or vegetable that is fit to be eaten by human beings;

"human excreta" means by-products of digestion that is faeces and urine.

Human excreta and dangerous substances not to be used as fertilizer

4. (1) No person shall use or allow to be used as a fertilizer in growing vegetables and edible plants, human excreta or any other dangerous substance.

(2) No person shall use raw waste water to irrigate vegetables and edible plants for use by human beings and animals.

(3) No person shall plant vegetables and edible plants along raw waste water flowing or logged areas.

(4) No person shall sell human excreta for use as a fertiliser.

Removal of vegetables and plants by designated officers

5. (1) A designated officer shall be entitled to slash or remove any vegetables and edible plants where—

(a) the vegetables and edible plants are being grown using human excreta or dangerous substances as fertilizer; or

(b) the vegetables and edible plants are being irrigated by raw waste water; or

(c) the vegetables and edible plants have been planted on raw waste water flowing or logged areas.

Offences and penalties

6. Any person who contravenes the provisions of these by-laws shall be liable to a fine specified in the Schedule.

SCHEDULE

OFFENCES AND PENALTIES

Description	Section	Amount (USD)
Use human excreta and dangerous substances as fertilizer	4	20,00
Sell human excreta and dangerous substances as fertilizer	4	20,00
Sell of vegetables or edible plants grown using human excreta and dangerous substances as a fertiliser	4	20,00
Obstructs an authorised official to exercise his or her duties	5	1005,00

The fines and penalties are payable in local currency at the prevailing Interbank rate.

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